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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title:

THE COCONUT HIVE IN CAPIZ: A GEST OF THE TREE OF LIFE

Proponent Name:	Ronilo G. Berondo
Academic Rank:	Instructor I
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	Study 1: Socio-Demographic Profile of Coconut Hive in the Province of Capiz Study 2. Coco Life: The Living Conditions of Coconut Planters/Farmers. Study 3. Coco Knot: Tying the Gap on the Status and Existing Policies for Coconut Strategic Directions and Development
Component Leader/s:	N/A
Academic Rank:	N/A

(2) Category (please check)

- ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields
☐ Natural/Biological Sciences
☐ Food Research
☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture
☐ Extension

(3) Research Center
[Check the concerned center]

- ☒ SSITRDC
 Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center

☐ LRDC
 Livestock Research Development Center

☐ FFRDC
 Fisheries and Food Research Development Center

☐ CSRDC
 Crop Science Research Development Center

(4) Site of implementation

Municipality/City: Tapaz

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Province:		Capiz
Region:		Region VI
(5) Classification Research: Development: ☐ Basic ☐ Pilot Testing ☒ Applied ☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization		(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☒ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☒ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
(7) Sector/Commodity Agriculture/Coconut		(8) Crop and Social Science

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(9) Rationale (State the research problem and significance of the project to the current needs of the country. The proposal should justify resource expenditure. A typical justification would include a brief introduction, a general statement concerning the historical basis for R & D and, thrusts being addressed, utilization of the expected output and the impact information generated will have on science, the target users and the country.)

Coconut, also known as the “tree of life” is one of the most important crops in the Philippines. It is considered a major export in contributing 3.6% of the country’s gross value-added (GVA) in agriculture, next to banana, corn and rice. Indeed, the country remains to be a top producer and exporter of coconut worldwide (PSA, 2019, Lapina and Andal 2017).

Coconut is currently planted in 3.6 million hectares of land, mostly in 69 provinces that host around 347 million fruit-bearing trees. However, much if not most of the 347 fruit-bearing coconut trees nationwide are of the low-yielding tall variety and not the high-yielding hybrid variety. And the tall varieties, which are decades old now, can yield only 50 coconuts per year, which is very low compared to hybrids developed locally that can yield from 100 to as much as 250 coconuts per year. But to undertake a massive replanting in the next five years, we need to produce hundreds of thousands or even millions of coconut seedlings through the somatic embryogenesis technology. However, producing more coconuts is just one component to uplift the socioeconomic standing of our coconut farmers, as they will earn more if they are given assistance to establish their own processing facilities. However, there should be careful planning to make sure the shared facilities will make coconut farmer organizations enter the value chain of the commodity, and make them viable business enterprises. And with assistance from the Department of Trade and Industry, these coconut farmer enterprises should be able to market their products to a wider domestic market and for export (Elemia, 2019).

In the province of Capiz, the Philippine Coconut Authority formally turned over the agrohub to the proponent, the Capiz Small Coconut Farmers Marketing Cooperative (CASCOFAMCO) last October 29, 2019. Ivisan Agrohub consists of a Coir Processing Complex and a Coconut Oil Processing Facility, located in Mianay and Ondoy Ivisan, respectively. The product lines of the Ivisan Oil Mill Facility include virgin coconut oil (VCO), refined cooking oil, crude oil, copra cake, coco water vinegar, and bath soap. As for the Coir-Charcoal Facility, the product lines are coir, hanks, coconets, cocologs, coco peat, and charcoal (PCA, 2019).

Considering coconut industry is an important pillar of Philippine agriculture, it’s development would mean significant welfare on the lives of Filipino people. The current study of the profiling of coconut hive in the province of Capiz will generate updated data on the status and condition of coconut planters and farmers. It will further elaborate on how coconut farmers organize into cooperatives that can operate like viable business enterprises which is crucial in the success of the Coconut Farmers and Industry Development Plan (CFIDP).

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(9-A) Project Description (Discuss the project strategy and plan of action of the project. It should also describe the technical procedures and other works needed to carry out the project objectives. The relationship of the project inputs and activities should be explained clearly in this section. Projects similar/related to the proposed project should be mentioned.)

(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem (for Social Sciences) (Statement of the specific purpose to address the problem areas of the project.)

The study generally aims to determine the profile of coffee production in the province of Capiz. Specifically, the study aims to attain the following objectives:

1. What is the current status of the coconut hive in terms of type of coffee planters/growers (local processors, and micro small and medium enterprises and distributors), type of geographical locations, engagement in product consumption and/or commercialization?
2. What are the issues, challenges, and concerns of coconut farmers/growers?
3. What is the extent of involvement of the coconut growers/farmers in industry planning, implementation, and extension activities of the LGU?
4. What is the extent of the production capacity, product quality, and market competitiveness of the coconut farmer/growers?

(11) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework (Include concepts, theories and variables that indicate relevant relationships to be tested.)

(12) Review of Literature (Related researchers/activities that have been conducted. State-of –the-art of current technology / information from which the project proposal will take-off).

Local coconut farmers' cooperative expanded its existing coconut processing project to include other products and by-products from the tree of life. Under its Integrated Coconut Processing Project, the Capiz Small Coconut Farmers Marketing Cooperative (CASCOFAMCO) will venture into the production of coconut coir dust, virgin oil, copra meal, vinegar and other by-products. ASCOFAMCO, which groups more than 3,000 small coconut farmers in the 16 towns and capital city of Capiz, has been operating since 1998 a village level coconut oil mill at Barangay Ondoy in Ivisan town. CASCOFAMCO is registered with the Cooperative Development Authority (CDA). PACAP is a bilateral development program that supports community-initiated, economically sustainable, ecologically sound and gender responsive efforts through financial assistance and multi-level capability building in partnership with non-government and people's organizations to improve the quality of life of poor communities. The province has about 13,000 hectares of coconut area with more than 24,000 farmers. (PIA, 2012).

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The Department of Trade and Industry (DTI) – Capiz on August 30, 2022 opened the Coco Bazaar Trade Fair cum Launching of Coconut Farmers Industry Development Plan at Robinsons Place, Roxas. The 3-day-long trade fair, which will run until September 1, features various local coconut products from Roxas City and the Province of Capiz. The activity is in line with the 36th National Coconut Week Celebration and was conducted in partnership with the Philippine Coconut Authority (PCA). One of the highlights of the activity is the launching of the Coconut Farmers Industry Development Plan (CFIDP). The CFIDP aims to increase the income and productivity of the coconut farmers in the country; promote poverty alleviation, education, and social equity; and rehabilitate and modernize the Philippine coconut industry. The CFIDP is composed of various components to be realized by the PCA, in partnership with other government agencies. It is encouraged that coconut farmers to not only plant coconut but become coco entrepreneurs. In the CFIDP System Framework, DTI will implement the research, marketing and market promotion.

According to Guillermo (2019), Capiz coconut farmers are assured of income with the new multi-million worth of coconut facility in the province with the completion of the P27-million Coconut Agro Hub Project in Barangay Ondoy, Ivisan, Capiz. It is expected to spur not only the province's economy but primarily the economic status of the coconut farmers. This new coconut facility will create employment, income and livelihood opportunities to the coco farmers especially that they have a sure buyer of their coconuts. The multi-million-peso Coconut AgroHub Project, courtesy of the PCA, consists of the Coco Coir Processing Complex in Mianay, Ivisan town and Coconut Oil Processing Facility in barangay Ondoy of same town. The said project aims to empower the coconut farmers by owning and operating their own small-medium enterprise coconut processing facilities. These facilities are designed for value-adding to traditional coconut products, thus, create more jobs, additional income and livelihood to the farmers, it will also serve as a learning facility for those who are interested in village-level processing. Aside from the coconut oil and coco coir, the CASCOFAMCO's facility had been producing virgin coconut oil, copra meal, copra cake and other coconut by-products.

(13) Methodology (Details such as; a) variables to be measured and evaluated; b) treatments to be used and their layout; c) experimental procedures and design; d) statistical analysis; e) evaluation method and observations to be made, strategies for implementation.)

1. Identification and Stratification of Coconut Hive in the Province of Capiz

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A letter from the Office of the University President, Vice President of Research Development and Extension and Director of Research requesting to visit the Department of Agriculture Office of the Province of Capiz will be secured to gather substantial information about the coconut in the whole province. All data and information to be obtained from the office will be purposely utilized only for research grounds. After successful gathering of relative and relevant information needed from the office, the selected areas for conducting the research will be stratified from the identified municipalities with the greatest number of existing coffee planter/growers/farmers and farms down to its respective barangays.

2. Sampling Technique and Procedure

The descriptive method of research will be used because; it describes and interprets what is. It concerns with conditions of relationships that exist; practices that prevail; beliefs, processes that are going on; effects that are being felt, or trends that are developing (Calderon and Gonzales, 1993).

All coffee planters/growers/farmers, farms, local processors, micro small and medium enterprises and distributors in the province of Capiz will be the target respondents of the study to obtain reliable and viable research data on profiling of Coffee industry in the territory.

3. Data to be Gathered

Study 1: Socio-Demographic Profile of Coconut Hive in the Province of Capiz

Study 2. Coco Life: The Living Conditions of Coconut Planters/Farmers.

Study 3. Coco Knot: Tying the Gap on the Status and Existing Policies for Coconut Strategic Directions and Development

4. Data Gathering Procedure, Area of Study and Duration

The main instrument in gathering data will be the questionnaires. The instruments will be distributed to the respondents to answer the questions followed by unstructured interview using guide questions. Retrieval of questionnaire will be done immediately to minimize the loss of data. the questionnaire from the respondents the data to be gathered are the personal and work-related characteristics. The study will be conducted at the identified with the most number of existing planters, growers, farmers, local processors, micro small and medium enterprises and distributors in the province estimated to be conducted within three months.

(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate in chronological order the task to be undertaken. Use gantt chart. Below is an example. This can be modified base on your desired Work plan.)

Research Objectives	Year 1										Year 2	
	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	June	July	Aug		
1. Preparation and presentation of research proposal												

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2. Data collection of existing coconut hive and growers in Capiz														
3. Preparation of checklist/questionnaires for intended data to be gathered														
4. Hiring of data entry staff/enumerators														
5. Distribution, gathering of data and collection of checklist/survey questionnaires on identified areas														
6. Recording, analysis and interpretation of the data gathered														

(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)

- Coconut Processed Products

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Design (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services to be transferred as extension activities)

(16) Targets Beneficiaries (Who the clienteles are and what are the expected outcome/effects of the use of the projects output)

- Future researchers
- Extension providers

(17) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role (Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization
Ronilo G. Berondo	Proponent	Social Science
Rey C. Castillon	Co-Author	Social Science
Rolly G. Gimoto	Co-Author	Social Science

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Louis Placido F. Lachica	Co-Author	Social Science
Leo Andrew B. Bicular	Co-Author	English/Literature

Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study

Program/Project Leader (in hours):

Program/Project Members (in hours):

(18) Budgetary Requirement

SOURCES OF EXPENSES	QUANTITY	UNIT	PRICE PER UNIT	TOTAL
SUPPLIES				
Printer (Epson L3150)	1	pc	9,000	9,000
Digital camera (Canon EOS 600D)	1	pc	18,000	18,000
Digital Weighing scale	1	pc	2,000	2,000
A4 size bond paper	10	reams	350	3,500
Black and colored inks	4	bottles	300	1,200
Tape measure	5	pcs	50	250
Recording Notebook	1	pc	80	80
Ballpen	10	pc	30	300
SUBTOTAL				34,250.00
Personnel Services (For studies needed the Research Assistant, informant/s, guide)				
Research Assistant	Days	90	500	45,000.00
Travel Allowance	Days	90	150	13,500
SUBTOTAL				58,500.00
TOTAL EXPENSES				92,750.00

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

Elemia, C. (2019). Why farmers feel betrayed by coc levy vetoes: Rappler.

Dar, W. (2017). State of the PH Coconut Industry and what must be done." The Manila Times

Guillermo, G. (2019). Capiz farmers to own P27-M coco facility. Retrived from: <https://www.dailyguardian.com.ph/capiz-farmers-to-own-p27-m-coco-facility/>

Lapina, B. & Andal, N.(2017). Supply and Demand in the Coconut Industry.

(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

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Date of Birth : March 9, 1985
Citizenship : Filipino
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